

Choose a publishing frequency you can maintain

Consistency matters more than frequency. A weekly show can create a strong listening habit, but it also means researching, recording, editing, packaging and promoting roughly 52 episodes a year. That is a serious commitment.



Use this step-by-step test:

- **Step 1:** Estimate how many hours one episode will require from idea to publication.
- **Step 2:** Multiply that by four to understand the likely monthly workload.
- **Step 3:** Compare that number with the time you can genuinely dedicate.
- **Step 4:** Add a buffer for cancelled guests, illness, travel and technical problems.
- **Step 5:** Choose the slowest cadence that still feels active and sustainable.

For some creators that means weekly; for others, fortnightly or seasonal publishing is smarter.

Episodic or Serial?

An episodic podcast allows listeners to start almost anywhere. Each episode stands largely on its own. Interviews, explainers and news programmes typically work this way.

A serial podcast tells a continuing story or course where episode order matters. Fiction, investigations and structured learning series often use this model.

If episodes must be heard in sequence, make that obvious in titles and introductions. New listeners should never have to guess where to begin.

Build a repeatable episode structure

Listeners appreciate familiarity. A repeatable structure also makes production easier.

A basic interview episode could look like this:

CREATE YOUR SHOW'S TEMPLATE

A show template is a short document that defines how your podcast works. It prevents every new episode from becoming a fresh strategic debate.

Create one with these headings:

- **Show name:** Your working title.
- **Listener promise:** The one-sentence proposition developed previously.
- **Primary audience:** Who the show serves.
- **Format:** Solo, interview, co-hosted, narrative or hybrid.
- **Tone:** For example, practical, curious, informal and evidence-driven.
- **Episode length:** A target range.
- **Publishing cadence:** Weekly, fortnightly, seasonal or another realistic schedule.
- **Episode structure:** Your standard sequence of segments.
- **Host roles:** Who researches, presents, edits and publishes.
- **Audio/video approach:** Audio-only, video-first or both.
- **Season plan:** The first ten episode ideas.
- **Success measure:** What would make the first season worthwhile?

Keep this document to one or two pages. You should be able to hand it to a collaborator and have them quickly understand the show.

1. **Cold open:** A compelling 15- to 30-second moment from the conversation.
2. **Introduction:** What the episode is about and why it matters.
3. **Guest setup:** A concise explanation of who the guest is.
4. **Main conversation:** Organised into two or three clear themes.
5. **Quick-fire section:** Shorter questions near the end.
6. **Key takeaway:** One useful idea to remember.
7. **Call to action:** Follow, subscribe, respond or explore related material.
8. **Credits:** Production information and necessary disclosures.

A solo educational show may use a problem-solution structure instead: hook, problem, explanation, examples, steps, summary and action.

Do not overcomplicate this. The purpose of structure is to make the experience easier to follow, not to make every episode sound robotic.

Scripted, outlined or improvised?

Fully scripted episodes provide control over wording, timing and